# Naimish Kakkad

**Principal Architect & Engineering Leader — API Platforms, Payments & Core Banking**

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## EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Principal Architect and Engineering Leader with 13+ years of experience designing and delivering large-scale digital banking, payments, and API platform ecosystems for regulated financial institutions.

Proven expertise leading architecture strategy and engineering teams across complex multi-vendor fintech environments. Experienced in building enterprise integration platforms, modernizing core banking systems, and enabling secure financial APIs.

Trusted advisor to executive leadership while remaining hands-on in enterprise architecture, cloud platforms, and engineering execution. Currently architecting next-generation banking platforms supporting 30+ credit unions.

## CORE EXPERTISE

Enterprise Architecture Leadership
Engineering Leadership (Architects & Tech Leads)
API Platforms & Integration Ecosystems
Payments Architecture (ISO8583, ISO20022)
Digital Banking & ATM Platforms
Core Banking Modernization (Mambu, Flexcube, Horizon)
Cloud Architecture (AWS & Azure)
Platform Governance & Architecture Standards
Vendor Platform Integration
Security & Compliance (PCI DSS)
DevOps, CI/CD & Observability

## PLATFORM IMPACT

Architecture leadership across a multi-institution banking ecosystem serving 30+ credit unions.

Platforms delivered:
• Digital banking integrations

• ATM and POS transaction processing
• Cardless cash withdrawal solutions
• Real-time payment integrations
• Core banking modernization programs
• Enterprise API governance and integration platforms

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### Persistent Systems — Principal Architect / Senior Architect

2020 – Present | Canada

Architecture and engineering leader responsible for defining enterprise integration strategy and platform architecture supporting League Data, the primary technology provider to 30+ Canadian credit unions.

Lead architecture governance and guide engineering teams delivering digital banking platforms, payment systems, and enterprise integration frameworks.

Engineering Leadership

• Lead and mentor technical architects, tech leads, and senior engineers responsible for core banking integrations and digital banking platforms.
• Define architecture standards for API lifecycle management, CI/CD, observability, and platform reliability.
• Guide distributed engineering teams implementing API-first and event-driven architectures across fintech ecosystems.

Enterprise Architecture & Platform Strategy

• Defined enterprise integration architecture across core banking, digital channels, payments, and fintech partner ecosystems.
• Architected next-generation banking architecture leveraging Mambu core banking, AWS cloud services, and MuleSoft API platform.
• Established reusable integration patterns enabling faster onboarding of fintech partners and banking vendors.

Diebold Nixdorf Strategic Platform Initiative

• Served as Senior Architect supporting a strategic initiative with Diebold Nixdorf to build an enterprise MuleSoft Anypoint Platform for Retail and Banking business units.
• Designed overall platform architecture for Azure-hosted self-managed MuleSoft Runtime Fabric deployed on AKS.
• Led API platform onboarding strategy enabling ATM systems, transaction engines, and digital banking channels to integrate through MuleSoft APIs.
• Architected integrations for ATM services including cardless cash withdrawal initiatives

and transaction orchestration platforms.
• Designed secure API-driven integration between ATM transaction engines and banking platforms to support high-volume financial transactions.

Payments & Financial Systems

• Architected payment integrations including Interac e-Transfer, ATM/POS card processing, AFT and bill payments.
• Designed payment messaging architecture supporting ISO8583 and ISO20022 standards.
• Implemented HSM-based security architecture for card authorization and transaction protection.

Security, Risk & Compliance

• Designed API security architecture using identity federation, OAuth tokens, and policy enforcement.
• Implemented platform observability including logging, metrics, and distributed tracing.
• Ensured solutions align with PCI DSS and financial security standards.

## TIAA — Senior Associate / Technical Lead

2016 – 2020

Led architecture and development of API-driven financial advisory platforms.

• Delivered enterprise APIs using MuleSoft and container platforms.
• Implemented CI/CD pipelines improving developer productivity and release reliability.
• Built secure integrations with identity platforms and regulatory compliance controls.

## Oracle Financial Services — Senior Developer

2014 – 2016

Worked on enterprise banking platforms using Oracle FLEXCUBE.

• Implemented core banking integrations for major banks including HDFC and YES Bank.
• Contributed to performance optimization and Exadata migration initiatives.
• Delivered APIs supporting private banking systems.

## Tata Consultancy Services — Assistant System Engineer

2012 – 2014

Developed enterprise Java APIs for global banking systems.

• Worked on JPMorgan Chase Global Trade platform.
• Delivered SOAP-to-REST modernization initiatives.

## TECHNOLOGY STACK

Integration & APIs: MuleSoft, ESB/SOA, Event-Driven Architecture
Cloud: AWS, Azure, AKS, Runtime Fabric
Languages: Java, J2EE, DataWeave
Containers: Docker, OpenShift, Kubernetes
DevOps: CI/CD Pipelines
Security: OAuth, Azure AD, Okta, API Gateway
Observability: Logging, Metrics, Tracing
Financial Systems: ISO8583, ISO20022, ATM/POS Networks, HSM

## EDUCATION

B.Sc. Information Technology — Saurashtra University (University Rank Holder)

## CERTIFICATIONS

- B.Sc. Information Technology — Saurashtra University (University First/Topper). Evidence
- Associate Member - The Institution of Electronics and Telecommunication Engineers (IETE), Evidence
- AWS Solutions Architect — Associate.
- MuleSoft: Platform Architect (L1), Integration Architect (L1), Developer (Mule 3 & Mule 4), Evidence , MuleSoft Delivery Champion. Evidence
- Mambu: Solution Consultant 1, Application Consultant, Integration Consultant, Orientation. Evidence
- MuleSoft Industry Playbook certified champion

## COMMUNITY CONTRIBUTION

- Meetup speaker/moderator: CI/CD, GDPR on Anypoint, API groups; sessions in NYC & Nagpur communities. Community Contribution
- Publications: CI/CD deep-dive (DZone 9.7K+ views); external identity with Anypoint + IDP